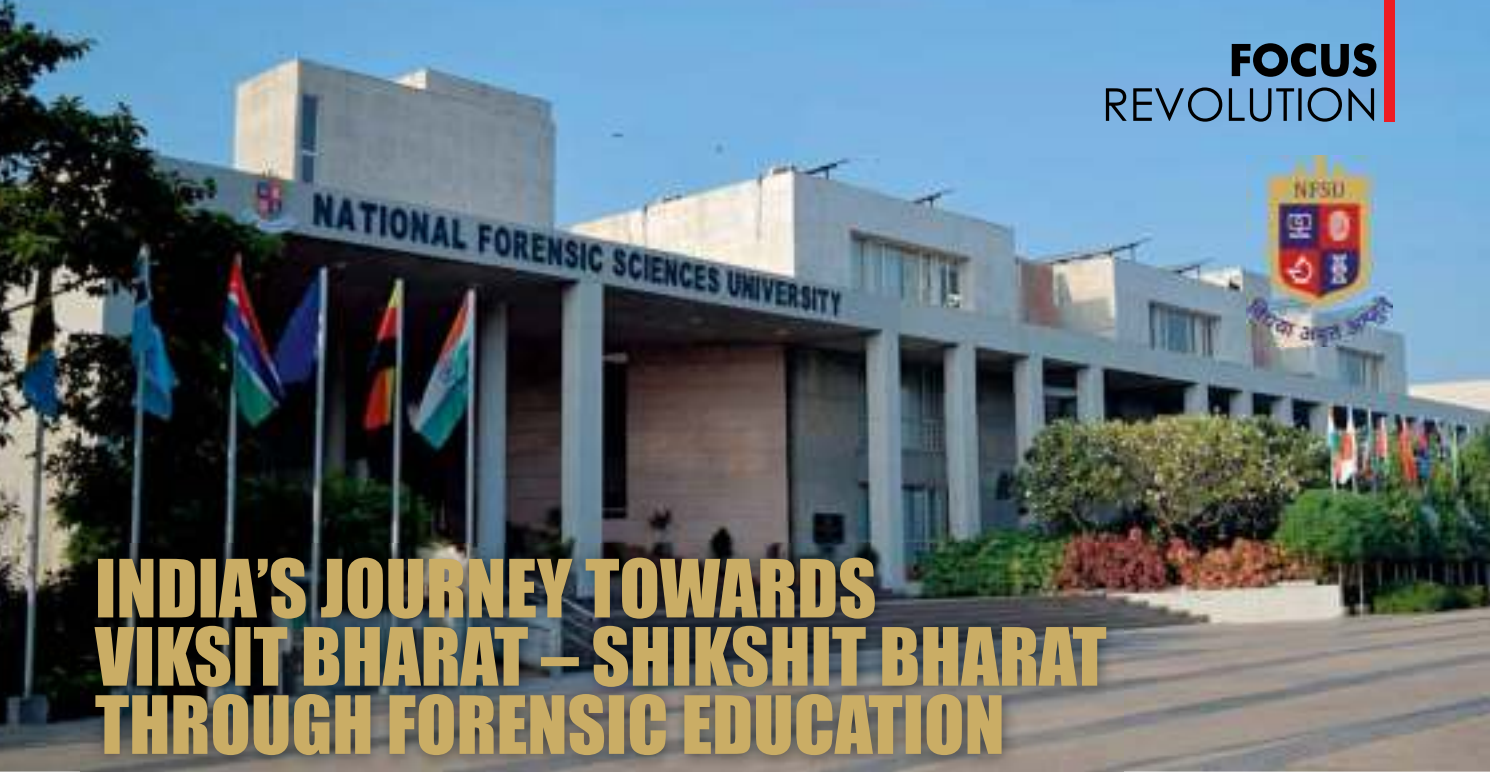


INDIA'S JOURNEY TOWARDS VIKSIT BHARAT – SHIKSHIT BHARAT THROUGH FORENSIC EDUCATION

As the tricolour is once again hoisted across the nation, we are reminded that freedom is not merely a historical milestone but an ongoing endeavour. The path to a truly developed India lies in freeing minds through education, nurturing innovation, and fostering leaders who act with integrity—principles that stand at the heart of the *Viksit Bharat – Shikshit Bharat vision*.

A Distinctive Force in Higher Learning

India's landscape of specialised education was transformed by the creation of National Forensic Sciences University (NFSU), the world's first and only university devoted entirely to forensic and investigative sciences, established under the visionary leadership of Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi in October 2020 through the Act of Parliament (32/2020). From its origins in Gujarat, the university under the founder Vice Chancellor Dr. J M Vyas (Padmashree Awardee) has grown into an Institution of National Importance and expanded into a nationwide network with 11 campuses at home, one abroad (Jinja, Uganda), and has set a goal of reaching every state.

The network of NFSU facilitates and promotes studies, research and fosters to achieve excellence in the field of forensic science in conjunction with applied behavioural science studies, law, criminology and other allied areas and technology and other related fields.

With about 70 programmes, drawn from its distinct schools, ranging from B.Sc. - M.Sc. Forensic Science, M.Sc. Forensic Science, M. Sc. Cyber Security, B. Tech. - M. Tech. Computer Science and Engineering (Cyber Security), M. Tech. Cyber Security, M. Sc. Digital Forensics and Information Security, B.Sc. Criminology and Forensic Science, M.Sc. Forensic Psychology, M. Pharm. Forensic Pharmacy, M. Tech. Civil Engineering (Specialisation in Forensic Structural Engineering), MBA Forensic Accounting and Fraud Investigation, and LL.M. (Cyber Law and Cyber Crime Investigation), etc. NFSU aims to impart quality and research-oriented education. Each course at NFSU is crafted not only to address today's security challenges but to anticipate those that lie ahead, producing graduates whose technical skills are matched by critical thinking, ethical judgement, and a deep sense of national duty.

Influence That Crosses Borders

The institution's reach extends well beyond India's frontiers. With more than 250 collaborative agreements—including membership in INTERPOL's Global Academy Network—it has forged a global knowledge bridge. Thousands of officers, both from India and over 70 other nations, have trained here. Many now serve in agencies such as the CBI, NIA, UN bodies, and leading forensic organisations, carrying with them expertise rooted in Indian scholarship and values.



Dr. J. M. Vyas, Vice Chancellor, NFSU

Innovation as a Guiding Principle

Research thrives within its multiple Centres of Excellence/ Centres, advancing projects in AI, nanotechnology, and advanced analytics. Efforts such as machine-learning tools for ballistics, predictive crime modelling, and quantum-safe cybersecurity place India firmly in the vanguard of forensic innovation.With the enforcement of the new criminal laws from July 2024, which mandates a report from a forensic expert for crimes where the punishment is 7 years or more, the demand has increased for trained forensic experts and the NFSU's expertise in the field of forensic science, and the available infrastructure has the potential to meet the demand of forensic experts/scientists. Destined to work for strengthening the Criminal Justice System by way of scientific investigation, the significance of NFSU experts can be gauzed from the special recognitions of Government of India where NFSU Faculty Members and Scientific Officers are declared as Government Scientific Experts under Section 329 of BNSS-2023 and also NFSU Cyber experts are declared as examiners of Electronic Evidence under Section 79 A of IT Act 2000. The launch of a Journal of Law and Artificial Intelligence signals an intent to shape the intersection of legal systems and emerging technology.

Looking Toward the Centenary

By 2047, the aim is to pioneer new domains—from space security to quantum forensics—while ensuring that high-quality education reaches every region. Such a vision ensures that the nation's growth remains both inclusive and future-ready. Independence is a journey, not a destination. As India moves toward its centenary, pioneering institutes like NFSU will continue to craft the guardians of justice, blending knowledge, ethics, and patriotism to secure the nation's future.